

gymbro

Install Guide

Get the workout tracker onto your own iPhone
and keep it running — no App Store needed.

Repository:

<https://github.com/gagangeet2517-arch/gymbro>

Free to install with any Apple ID · your data stays on your phone

1. What is gymbro?

gymbro is a personal workout and nutrition tracker. You log workouts from ready-made templates, snap photos of meals to count calories with AI, and watch your strength and bodyweight trends on charts. Everything is stored on your phone — no account, no sign-up, no cloud.

Because gymbro is not on the App Store, you install it yourself from a Mac using a free Apple ID. The install lasts **7 days**, then the app stops opening until you re-run one command to refresh it (your data is never lost). This guide covers the one-time setup, the install, and the weekly refresh.

2. What you need

- **A Mac** — any Apple-silicon or recent Intel Mac.
- **Xcode** — free, from the Mac App Store (large download, ~1 hour first time).
- **Node.js** — free, from nodejs.org (choose the LTS installer).
- **Your iPhone + a USB cable.**
- **An Apple ID** — the free one you already have is enough. No paid developer account.
- About **30–40 minutes** for the one-time setup. After that, reinstalls take ~3 minutes.

3. One-time setup — get the code onto your Mac

- 1 Install **Xcode** from the Mac App Store, open it once, and accept the licence.
- 2 Install **Node.js** (LTS) from nodejs.org.
- 3 Open the **Terminal** app (press **⌘-Space**, type "Terminal", press Enter).
- 4 Copy-paste these three lines one at a time, pressing Enter after each:

```
git clone https://github.com/gagangeet2517-arch/gymbro.git
cd gymbro
npm install
```

Note: Type or paste each line exactly. The most common beginner mistake is running a folder path on its own (for example dragging the folder into Terminal and pressing Enter) — that gives permission denied. Always start with `cd` followed by a space to move into a folder.

4. One-time setup — connect your Apple ID and iPhone

Apple requires every app on a real iPhone to be "signed". You do this once in Xcode:

- 1 In Terminal, run `open ios/gymbro.xcworkspace` — Xcode opens the project.
- 2 Xcode menu → **Settings** → **Accounts** → "+" → sign in with your Apple ID.
- 3 Click the blue **gymbro** icon in the left sidebar, open the **Signing & Capabilities** tab, tick **Automatically manage signing**, and pick your name under **Team**.
- 4 Plug in your iPhone with the cable, unlock it, and tap **Trust** when the phone asks.
- 5 On the iPhone, turn on **Settings** → **Privacy & Security** → **Developer Mode** (the phone restarts once).

Then find your phone's device id — run this in Terminal:

```
xcrun devicectl list devices
```

Copy the long **Identifier** shown for your phone. Open the file `package.json` in the gymbro folder (double-click opens TextEdit), find the `deploy:iphone` line, and replace the device id (the long code after `id=`, it appears twice) with yours. Replace the `DEVELOPMENT_TEAM` value with your own team id — Xcode shows it under Signing & Capabilities after you pick your team.

5. Install the app on your iPhone

Phone plugged in and unlocked? This is the whole thing:

```
cd ~/Desktop/gymbro          # or wherever you cloned it
npm run deploy:iphone
```

The first build takes several minutes. When it finishes you will see **"App installed"** and gymbro appears on your home screen. Open it, swipe through the welcome tour, and you are in.

Note: First launch only: if the icon shows an "Untrusted Developer" message, go to iPhone **Settings** → **General** → **VPN & Device Management**, tap your Apple ID and tap **Trust**. Then open the app again.

6. The 7-day rule (important!)

Apps signed with a free Apple ID stop launching after **7 days**. This is an Apple restriction, not a bug. When gymbro suddenly refuses to open:

- 1 Plug the iPhone into the Mac and unlock it.
- 2 Open Terminal and run the same two lines as always:

```
cd ~/Desktop/gymbro
npm run deploy:iphone
```

That refreshes the app for another 7 days. **All your workouts, meals, and settings survive every reinstall** — the data lives in the app's own storage on the phone and reinstalling on top never wipes it.

7. After an iPhone (or Mac) software update

System updates can break the developer connection between phone and Mac. Symptoms: the app stops opening early, or the install command fails saying the device is **unavailable**. Fix, in order:

- 1 Plug the phone in with the cable and keep it **unlocked**.
- 2 Tap **Trust** if the phone asks again after the update.
- 3 Check **Settings** → **Privacy & Security** → **Developer Mode** is still ON (updates sometimes switch it off; the phone reboots when you re-enable it).
- 4 Run `xcrun devicectl list devices` — your phone should say **available (paired)**. Then run the usual `npm run deploy:iphone`.

8. Turn on the AI features (optional, free)

Photo food scanning, voice meal logging, and the nutrition coach use Google Gemini. They need a free key — one minute to set up:

- 1 On any device, go to aistudio.google.com/apikey, sign in with a Google account, and create an API key. Copy it.
- 2 In gymbro: **Home tab** → **tap your Profile**.
- 3 Scroll to **AI features · Gemini key**, paste the key, tap **Save profile**.
- 4 The status line changes to **"Using your key"** — AI features are now on.

Note: If photo scan or the coach say "Add your Google Gemini API key in Profile", this step has not been done yet. The key is stored only on your phone.

9. Quick tour — getting the most out of gymbro

- **Workouts tab** — start from a template (Push / Pull / Legs / Upper). gymbro pre-fills the weights and reps from your last session so you can focus on beating them. You can add or remove exercises mid-workout, and a warm-up / cool-down checklist is built in for every session.
- **Guided mode** — tap **Guide me** during a workout for a one-set-at-a-time view with a built-in rest timer between sets.
- **Voice logging** — tap the mic on any exercise (or in guided mode) and say your set, e.g. "sixty by eight" — it fills in the weight and reps for you. Runs on your phone's own speech engine, not the AI key, so it works offline and costs nothing.
- **Nutrition tab** — photograph your plate, speak your meal, or scan a barcode. Late-night meals (after midnight) ask whether they count toward yesterday or today.
- **Progress tab** — log bodyweight and body fat %; charts for strength, volume, and body trends fill in automatically. Finishing a workout shows calories burned.
- **Home tab** → **Profile** — set your **Training goal** (fat loss / lean bulk / maintenance / recomp: it tunes templates and nutrition targets), pick habit goals, and set **reminders**: a daily one and a long-term one with your own goal text (for example "Lose 5 kg by August 1st").

Note: Reminders ask for notification permission the first time you enable one — tap Allow. If reminders never appear, check iPhone Settings → gymbro → Notifications.

Note: The app explains itself as you go: the first time you reach a feature like guided mode, voice logging, or reminders, a small dismissible card appears describing what it does. It only shows once per feature and disappears for good once you try it or tap the X.

10. Troubleshooting

10.1 Terminal says "permission denied"

- You probably ran a folder path as a command (for example by dragging the folder into Terminal). Use `cd` + the folder, then the npm command, as two separate lines.
- If it says "Operation not permitted" instead: System Settings → Privacy & Security → **Files and Folders** → **Terminal** → allow **Desktop Folder**, then quit and reopen Terminal.

10.2 The app icon does nothing / app will not open

The 7-day signature has expired. Reinstall (section 6). Your data is safe.

10.3 "Untrusted Developer" when opening the app

iPhone Settings → General → VPN & Device Management → tap your Apple ID → Trust.

10.4 Install fails / device "unavailable"

The phone-to-Mac developer link dropped (common after updates). Follow section 7.

10.5 Build fails with a signing error

Open `ios/gymbro.xcworkspace` in Xcode and re-check Signing & Capabilities (section 4) — your free signing certificate may have expired; picking the team again renews it.

10.6 AI features say a key is missing

Add your free Gemini key in Profile (section 8).

11. Where to get help

- Open an issue at github.com/gagangeet2517-arch/gymbro/issues — describe what you tapped and what happened.
- Google AI Studio (free Gemini keys) — aistudio.google.com
- For developers who want to modify the app: the project is a standard Expo / React Native codebase — see the README at github.com/gagangeet2517-arch/gymbro.

This PDF is generated from `scripts/make_setup_pdf.py` — edit that file and re-run it to update the guide.